



Above The Hôtel Dieu des Hospices de Beaune was built at the end of the Hundred Years War, when Burgundy suffered both poverty and famine

Left The vineyards of the Hautes-Côtes de Beaune spill down the long slopes of the Côte d'Or escarpment, seen here in fall



Above A great boeuf bourguignon depends on the integrity of its ingredients, specifically Charolais beef and red Burgundy wine

Cookery Classes

A cooking class at **The Cook's Atelier** (www.thecooksatelier.com) kicks off in style with a glass of chilled *crémant*, Burgundy's bubbly. Marjorie Taylor's menu pays homage to the small artisan producers of the region.

La Terre d'Or (www.laterredor.com) will arrange a session at the stove of a Michelin-starred restaurant with a winemaker on hand to discuss the best partner wines. Learn how to visually recognize, smell, and taste regional wines in a three-hour crash course at **Ecole des Vins de Bourgogne** (www.ecoledesvins-bourgogne.com). Longer sessions are also available.

The Best Places to Eat Boeuf Bourguignon

Ma Cuisine inexpensive

Tucked down a side street off the Place Carnot, this cozy restaurant run by husband-and-wife team Pierre and Fabienne has amassed thousands of fans over the years, not just for the well-cooked regional specialties they turn out but equally for the wine list (featuring more than 700 bottles) – this is Burgundy, after all. Ma Cuisine is resolutely, unrepentantly old-fashioned, and that's exactly why people keep coming back. If you crave waistline-friendly, edgy food, give this rustic roost a wide berth. The entrées sound a roll call for old rural France: *jambon persillé* (cubed ham with parsley in aspic), Burgundy's famed *escargots* (snails) served in their shells brimming with parsley butter, and wobbly *oeufs en meurette* (eggs poached in red wine). Main courses run from roasted whole pigeon to soul-warming favorites such as *coq au vin* (chicken in – of course – red wine) and plush, dark, meltingly tender boeuf bourguignon. To finish, try a fresh fruit tart or an eggy *crème brûlée*.

Passage Sainte-Hélène, Beaune; open for lunch and dinner Mon, Tue, Thu & Fri; +33 380 223 022

Also in Beaune

The cool contemporary decor of Bruno Monnoir's **Le Benaton** (www.lebenaton.com; *expensive*) is typified by the tan ostrich-leather chairs. It is advance warning that there are no fusty old classics here; instead, you can expect a sophisticated and inventive reworking of Burgundy's culinary traditions. Monnoir's highly refined take on boeuf bourguignon features "nuts" of beef cheek confited in red wine.

Also in France

Those old-world Paris bistros with proper linen tablecloths and food that deserves a return visit seem to be a disappearing breed, but **Josephine Chez Dumonet** (+33 1 4548 5240; *moderate*), in the city's 6th arrondissement, is valiantly fighting the trend – and winning. French classics dominate this menu: steak tartare, crispy-skin *confit de canard*, omelet with truffles (in season, of course), and spoon-tender boeuf bourguignon. This restaurant is reason enough for a Paris stopover.

Around the World

Bustling **Brasserie Les Halles** (www.leshalles.net/brasserie; *inexpensive*) is a typical Parisian restaurant serving up a host of French classics – except it's doing it in New York. The kitchen home of chef, author, and straight-talking television host Anthony Bourdain, the restaurant takes its name from Paris's once-thriving, now defunct, market district Les Halles. It's open from noon to midnight, so you can slake a craving for rib-sticking boeuf bourguignon almost any time of day.